UNIT 2: KNOW YOURSELF

TOPIC 4: SHORT-TERM GOAL SETTING

Topic OBJECTIVES: The learner will:

- Learn the definition of a short-term goal
- Understand that short-term goals can be seen as "steps to success"

Topic OUTCOME: The learner will:

- Choose personal short-term goals utilizing the steps outlined in the lesson for present and future goal setting

Topic ACTIVITIES:

Large Group Discussion

Objective: Students will understand the definition of a short-term goal.

Time: 15 minutes

Materials: Chalkboard/chalk or chart paper/markers

"If you don't know where you are going, you will probably end up somewhere else." ~ *Eleanor Roosevelt*

"You have to expect things from yourself, before you can do them." ~ *Michael Jordan*

Write these quotes in front of the group, and ask students to explain what they think these quotes might mean, in terms of jobs and careers. Explain that a goal is something someone wants or needs to do. Additionally, short-term goals can be seen as steps on a ladder to get to where you want to go.

Explain that when deciding on a short-term goal, it should be specific, realistic, and measurable. Write these three terms on the board/chart paper, and define in relation to goals. Encourage any students who feel comfortable to share a time they have set and achieved a short-term goal (completed an assignment on time, practiced a sport every day to improve, etc.), and how it fit the three items.

Writing/Reflection/Assessment

Objective: Students will decide on and set one short-term (within 2 weeks) goal relating to work or training.

Time: 20 minutes

Materials: Handout: **"Short-Term Goal Sheet,"** pens/pencils

Ask students to choose a short-term goal related to work/training (such as applying for a specific job, signing up for a GED class, or going to a Career Center to learn about youth internships) and fill out the **"Short-Term Goal Sheet."** In two weeks, check in with the students one-on-one to see if they were able to complete their goal.

Ask students to work on a final version by encouraging them to check spelling, grammar, neatness, and accuracy of their work. Ask them to keep the final copy in their portfolio as a reminder of steps to take to achieve a goal.

Technical (Mass CIS)/Research

Objective: Students will view goals as building blocks towards achievement and success.

Time: 25 minutes

Materials: Computers with internet connection

Ask the students to go to the website **www.wgby.org/localprograms/mihteenstyle.org,** and click the **"Watch Full Teen Episodes Online"** link at the bottom of the page. Then, have them choose an episode where the jobs featured are of the most interest to them. Ask them to consider, when watching, what short-term goals the young people featured in the show may have used to get their job or what short-term goal setting they may need to do currently in the workplace.

Short-Term Goal Sheet

Name: Date:

Directions: *Answer the questions below by responding in writing to each one.*

What career field(s) interest you at this time?

What can you be doing now to move toward the career fields/areas noted above?

What school or career-related goals do you have for yourself right now? Write it in the space below.

Note: Pick **one** you can reasonably accomplish in two weeks and follow this blueprint for achieving your goal.

Goal:

I'm going to (what)

by (when)

State why this is a worthwhile goal:

State in writing:

It is realistic for me to try to meet this goal because

Rate how hard you intend to work toward this goal:

10 9 8 7 6 5 4 3 2 1
Hard Hardly at all

Stepping Up:

If possible, take the goal apart by breaking it down into several smaller parts. Give yourself a deadline for each step.

Step #1 Deadline:

Step #2 Deadline:

Step #3 Deadline:

Adapted from Merging Two Worlds, 2003



Choice-Making Self-Check

1. Identify my goal...

_____

_____

2. What are my options?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

3. What might happen?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

4. The Best Choice

_____

5. TAKE ACTION!!!

6. How did I do?

_____

_____

7. Did I meet my goal?

No!

Yes!

8. My NEW goal is...

_____

_____

9. Reward Yourself!

_____

_____

Session 4, form 4.2 blank

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